

MACCESS INC.

Private Security LA Worldwide | PPO #122729 | BSIS-Authorized Training Provider

WORKPLACE VIOLENCE

BSIS Elective Skills Course — Security Guard Training

Authority: BPC §7583.6(b) | CA Labor Code §6401.9 (SB 553, eff. July 1, 2024) | Cal/OSHA | 4 Hours

What SB 553 Requires (Eff. July 1, 2024)

Every California employer must establish, implement, and maintain a written Workplace Violence Prevention Plan (WVPP)

WVPP must be site-specific — Cal/OSHA model plan available as a starting template

Employers must train ALL employees on the WVPP — training must be repeated annually

Maintain a Violent Incident Log documenting every threat or violent event

Review and update the plan annually and after every workplace violence incident

Non-retaliation: employees cannot be punished for reporting threats or seeking law enforcement help

Penalties: up to \$25,000 for serious violations; up to \$158,727 for willful violations

Four Types of Workplace Violence (Cal/OSHA)

TYPE 1 — External/Criminal: Violence by persons with no legitimate relationship to the workplace (robbery, trespass, active shooter)

TYPE 2 — Customer/Client: Violence directed at employees by clients, patients, customers, or students (most common type)

TYPE 3 — Worker-on-Worker: Violence by a current or former employee, supervisor, or manager against another employee

TYPE 4 — Personal Relationship: Violence by someone with a personal relationship (domestic violence) that enters the workplace

Security guards face elevated risk of Type 1 and Type 2 violence (Cal/OSHA)

All four types require specific prevention measures in the employer's WVPP

MODULE 1

Detecting Unusual Behavior & Warning Signs

Worker-to-Worker | Client-to-Customer | Supervisor-to-Subordinate | BSIS Syllabus §11.1

Behavioral Warning Signs

Repeated expressions of grievances about perceived unfair treatment, feeling targeted, or being disrespected

Increased irritability, mood swings, or emotional volatility without apparent cause

Withdrawal from coworkers and previously normal social interactions

Making direct or indirect threats — 'Someone is going to pay for this,' 'I know where they live'

Fixation on prior conflicts, disciplinary actions, or personal grudges

Bringing weapons-related items to work or making unusual references to weapons

History of violence or aggressive behavior in previous employment

Environmental & Situational Indicators

Sudden changes in work performance — missed deadlines, increased errors, poor attendance

Extreme reaction to feedback, criticism, or discipline that is disproportionate

Evidence of personal crisis: domestic problems, financial stress, substance abuse

Blaming others exclusively for all problems — refusing any personal accountability

Statements suggesting the employee feels trapped, hopeless, or has nothing to lose

Increased interest in workplace conflicts of other employees — positioning as an ally

Document ALL observations objectively — report to supervisor, do NOT confront alone

Warning Signs — Client/Customer to Employee & Supervisor to Subordinate Module 1 | BSIS Syllabus §11.1

Client / Customer to Employee Warning Signs

Escalating verbal aggression — profanity, personal insults, raised voice that is not de-escalating

Physical intimidation — invading personal space, blocking exits, pointing, aggressive gesturing

Repeated contacts with same employee that feel threatening or obsessive

Statements of entitlement combined with threats when denied: 'You'll regret this'

History of prior aggressive or threatening behavior at this location

Visible signs of intoxication combined with agitation

Type 2 violence: most common form — security guards are a primary target

Supervisor to Subordinate Warning Signs

Patterns of humiliation, public criticism, or belittling of specific employees

Disproportionate disciplinary actions or selective enforcement — targeting individual employees

Threats of termination used as a means of control rather than legitimate management

Isolation tactics — removing employees from projects, communications, or team activities

Retaliation against employees who report safety concerns or harassment

Creating a climate of fear where employees are afraid to report problems

Guard's role: document and report to MACCESS INC. management — do not take sides in personnel matters

MODULE 2

Anger Management

Understanding the anger cycle | De-escalation strategies | The guard's role in managing volatile encounters | BSIS Syllabus §11.2

Understanding Anger — The Escalation Cycle

Module 2 | BSIS Syllabus §11.2 | BPC §7583.7(b)(6)

1 TRIGGER

Perceived injustice, frustration, fear, or threat — the starting point of the anger cycle

2 ESCALATION

Rising tension — voice louder, body language aggressive, reasoning impaired

3 CRISIS

Peak of anger — violence risk is highest — de-escalation is still possible but requires skilled intervention

4 RECOVERY

Tension begins to drop — person may feel embarrassed or regret — do not resume confrontation

5 POST-CRISIS

Relative calm returns — document the incident — follow up through proper channels

De-escalation Strategies for Angry Persons

Stay calm — your tone and body language model the response you want from the other person

Lower your voice when they raise theirs — do not match their energy

Use their name if known — humanizes the interaction and breaks the anger cycle

Validate the emotion without validating the behavior: 'I can see you're very frustrated'

Give them an 'out' — a face-saving choice that lets them de-escalate without feeling defeated

Create distance — do not crowd, do not touch unless required for safety

Use time — 'Let me get someone who can help resolve this' — buys space without capitulation

Guard's Limits — When to Escalate

You are NOT a therapist — do not try to resolve deep personal grievances

If de-escalation is not working after 2-3 minutes: request backup, notify supervisor

If physical threat appears imminent: create distance, call 911, do not attempt to restrain alone

Never argue about who is 'right' — focus on the behavior, not the underlying grievance

Do not issue ultimatums unless prepared to follow through immediately

Document every significant angry encounter in writing — date, time, parties, what was said, outcome

MACCESS INC. policy: report all threatening encounters to your supervisor within 1 hour

MODULE 3

Valuing Diversity

How cultural differences affect workplace conflict | Guard's role in equitable, consistent enforcement | BSIS Syllabus §11.3

Cultural Influences on Conflict

Conflict expression varies across cultures — what appears aggressive may be normal communication in another cultural context

Direct vs. indirect communication: some cultures express disagreement loudly and openly; others communicate displeasure more subtly

Power distance: attitudes toward authority and supervisors differ by cultural background — some employees are conditioned not to challenge authority openly

Do not interpret culturally unfamiliar behavior as inherently threatening — investigate before assuming

Language barriers can cause misunderstandings that escalate into apparent conflict — use translation tools, remain patient

Document observed behaviors only — never document cultural background or national origin as a risk factor

Equitable Enforcement & Guard's Role

Apply the same standard to every person regardless of race, ethnicity, religion, gender, age, or national origin

Disparate enforcement of workplace violence policies is a FEHA violation and creates civil liability

Recognize your own implicit biases — your response to an angry white male vs. an angry Black male must be identical

Language access: employees with limited English have the same right to report workplace violence — seek an interpreter

Diverse teams are stronger: inclusion reduces the resentment and isolation that drive Type 3 violence

Build community trust through consistency — people comply with authority they see as fair and impartial

MODULE 4

Personal Security

Protecting yourself on the job | Environmental design | Situational awareness | Active shooter response | BSIS Syllabus §11.4

Environmental Security Measures

CPTED (Crime Prevention Through Environmental Design): proper lighting, sightlines, controlled access, elimination of blind spots

Access control: secure all entry points — ensure only authorized persons reach sensitive areas

Panic buttons and duress alarms: know the location and function of every alarm at your post

CCTV coverage: know your camera positions and which areas have gaps in coverage

Workspace layout: position front-facing staff so they have a clear exit route behind them

Communication devices: confirm your radio is charged and tested before every shift

Post awareness: review any prior incident history for your assignment before starting patrol

Personal Situational Awareness & Response

Yellow alert (baseline): maintain continuous relaxed awareness — know who is around you at all times

Trust your instincts: if something feels wrong, act on the training — don't dismiss it

Reactionary gap: maintain 6-10 feet from unknown or agitated persons

Buddy system: for high-risk contacts, request backup — do not approach alone

Run-Hide-Fight: active shooter protocol — your first duty is evacuate civilians, not engage the threat

When law enforcement arrives: hands visible, follow all commands, announce yourself clearly

Post-incident: after any violent incident, seek a supervisor debrief and document your own wellbeing

Active Shooter & Violent Incident Response

Module 4 | BSIS Syllabus §11.4 | DHS Run-Hide-Fight



RUN

If a safe escape path exists — leave immediately. Leave belongings. Help others escape if possible. Do not let others stop you. Call 911 from a safe distance.



HIDE

If escape is not possible — get out of the shooter's view. Lock/barricade the door. Silence your phone. Turn off lights. Stay low. Remain quiet until law enforcement clears.



FIGHT

Last resort only — if your life is in imminent danger. Act aggressively. Improvise weapons. Commit fully to the action. Yell to disorient and attract attention.

Security guards: your PRIMARY role is protecting lives — not engaging the threat. Evacuate and call 911.

MODULE 5

Reporting

SB 553 Violent Incident Log | What must be reported | MACCESS INC. chain of command | Documentation standards |
BSIS Syllabus §11.5

Reporting — What Must Be Reported & When

Module 5 | BSIS Syllabus §11.5 | CA Labor Code §6401.9

What Requires Reporting

Any threat of violence — direct or indirect — made to or by an employee or client at the post

Any physical act of violence — including pushing, grabbing, or striking — regardless of injury outcome

Any situation where an employee feared for their safety, even if no physical contact occurred

Suspicious behavior that may indicate a planned violent act

Any weapon observed on premises by an unauthorized person

Active shooter or armed threat — call 911 first, notify supervisor immediately after

SB 553 (Labor Code §6401.9): employers MUST log all violent incidents — your report feeds that log

How to Report — Chain of Command

STEP 1 — Ensure safety: remove yourself and others from immediate danger before reporting

STEP 2 — Call 911 if there is any immediate threat to life — do not delay for paperwork

STEP 3 — Notify your MACCESS INC. supervisor immediately — verbal first, written within 1 hour

STEP 4 — Complete a written incident report: date/time/location, parties involved, exactly what was said and done, witnesses, actions taken

STEP 5 — Preserve evidence: do not clean up the area, save CCTV footage, collect witness contact info

STEP 6 — Client notification: MACCESS INC. management will notify the client — not the guard directly

Anti-retaliation: employees who report threats cannot be punished — Labor Code §6401.9

Violent Incident Log — Required Elements (CA Labor Code §6401.9)

Date, time, and location of the incident

Type of workplace violence (Type 1 / 2 / 3 / 4) — see Module 1

Description of the incident: what occurred, what was threatened or done, who was involved

Classification of who perpetrated the violence (stranger, customer, coworker, supervisor, domestic partner, etc.)

Circumstances at the time of the incident — staffing levels, activities underway, location characteristics

Consequences of the incident — injuries, medical treatment required, law enforcement contacted

Names of persons involved (employees by job title only to protect confidentiality)

Log must be maintained for a minimum of 5 years and made available to employees and Cal/OSHA on request

MACCESS INC. maintains the Violent Incident Log for the PPO — your written incident report is the source document that feeds it



Course Complete

Workplace Violence — BSIS Elective Skills Course

Proceed to the online assessment. A score of 100% is required to receive your Certificate of Completion per BPC §7583.6(b).